



Privacy and Safety Statement

Study Association GEARS

April 22, 2026

Privacy and Safety Statement

Study Association GEARS, hereafter referred to as “GEARS”, processes the personal information of its members to achieve its primary goals, as defined in its statutes. This document outlines what information GEARS processes, for what purposes, and how we ensure the privacy and safety of our members.

1 Introduction

GEARS is committed to protecting the privacy and personal safety of its members. This statement explains our policies regarding the collection, use, and protection of personal data, as well as our responsibilities for ensuring a safe environment for all members.

2 Personal Data Collection and Use

2.1 Necessity and Scope

GEARS processes the personal information of individuals from the moment they engage in a membership or contributor agreement. It is not possible to become a member without providing the required personal information. GEARS does not engage in automatic profiling and only processes data that members explicitly provide.



2.2 Types of Information and Purposes

During and after membership, GEARS processes the following information:

Information Type	Purpose
Name and surname	Identification of members and contributors
Date of birth	Compliance with age-related legislation
Gender	Anonymized statistical analysis
Nationality	Anonymized statistical analysis
Residential information	Delivery of magazines and written communication
Phone number	Emergency contact
Email address	Communication and general assembly invitations
IBAN	Processing of membership fees
BIC	Processing of membership fees
Student number	Requesting university subsidies
Field of study	Anonymized statistical analysis
Starting year	Anonymized statistical analysis
Study phase	Anonymized statistical analysis
Date of registration	Administrative and archival purposes

3 Data Sharing and Security

3.1 Sharing with Third Parties

GEARS does not supply personal information to third parties except when necessary for operational or legal reasons. GEARS does not generate income from personal data. Structural data exchange occurs only with the University of Groningen and Conscribo online accounting, under strict processing agreements.

3.2 Data Security

GEARS prioritizes the security and privacy of its members. Nearly all digital systems are developed and hosted in-house. Personal data is only shared with third parties if it directly benefits the association and its members, and only with parties that uphold the same security and privacy standards.

4 Data Retention

GEARS retains financial records, including personal data, for seven years after the termination of membership, unless otherwise required by law.

5 Member Rights

Members have the right to:

- Access their personal data held by GEARS



- Request correction of inaccurate information
- Request deletion of their data
- Receive their data in a portable format

For all requests, members should contact the secretary of the board or update their profile via the GEARS website.

6 Personal Safety Responsibility

GEARS is committed to ensuring the personal safety of its members during all association activities. This includes:

- Providing a safe environment at events and meetings
- Ensuring compliance with all relevant health and safety regulations
- Offering support and resources for members in need
- Maintaining clear communication channels for reporting safety concerns

Members are encouraged to report any safety issues or concerns to the board immediately.

7 Complaints and Contact

Complaints regarding data processing or personal safety can be submitted via the Dutch Data Protection Authority (autoriteitpersoonsgegevens.nl) or directly to the GEARS board. We encourage members to contact us first, as we are committed to resolving issues promptly and collaboratively.

